CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
Knight Center, 655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305
christiankontz.com ◇ ckontz@stanford.edu

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
Dissertation Committee: Hanno Lustig (chair), Juliane Begenau, Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

University of Hamburg *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

JOB MARKET PAPER

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
   - Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade 2025 PhD Student Award

WORKING PAPERS

1. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   - Winner of UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students
2. *From Markets to Meters: How Index Investing Affects Electricity Prices*

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
2. *Does Index Investing Lower Expected Returns? Evidence From Option Markets*
3. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

PRESENTATIONS (⋆SCHEDULED, ^{c}CO-AUTHOR)

AFA Annual Meeting⋆ *2026*

Carey Finance Conference⋆, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (UHH)⋆, Citadel⋆, SFS Cavalcade, FIRS Conference, Four Corners Conference on Indexing, Investment Company Institute, Northeastern Uni Finance Conference, UIC Finance Conference^{c}, AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster) *2025*

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, GRASFI Conference, OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster), UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo), Citadel^{c} *2024*

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster), UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School *2023*

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

US Census Bureau *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

University of Chicago *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

Princeton University *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

University of Hamburg *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Base Finance, TA to Juliane Begenau	*2022, 2023*
Capital Markets and Institutional Investing, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall	*2023, 2024, 2025*
Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy, TA to Amit Seru	*2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Debt Markets, TA to Darrell Duffie	*2021, 2022*
Modeling for Investment Management, TA to Steven Grenadier	*2023, 2024, 2025*

University of Hamburg

Macroeconomics 1 (UG), TA to Kristin Paetz	*2016*

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Shortlisted for Brandes Center Prize 2024	*2025*
UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2025*
SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award	*2025*
Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship	*2025-2026*
Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI)	*2025*
American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting)	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2024*
Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize	*2024*
GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award	*2024*
Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business	*2020–2025*
Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University	*2018–2020*
Undergraduate and Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2015–2018*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science
Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*)	*2011–2014*
Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant)	*2009–2011*

Last updated: October 2025